# Lab 2. Inspecting API Mechanics

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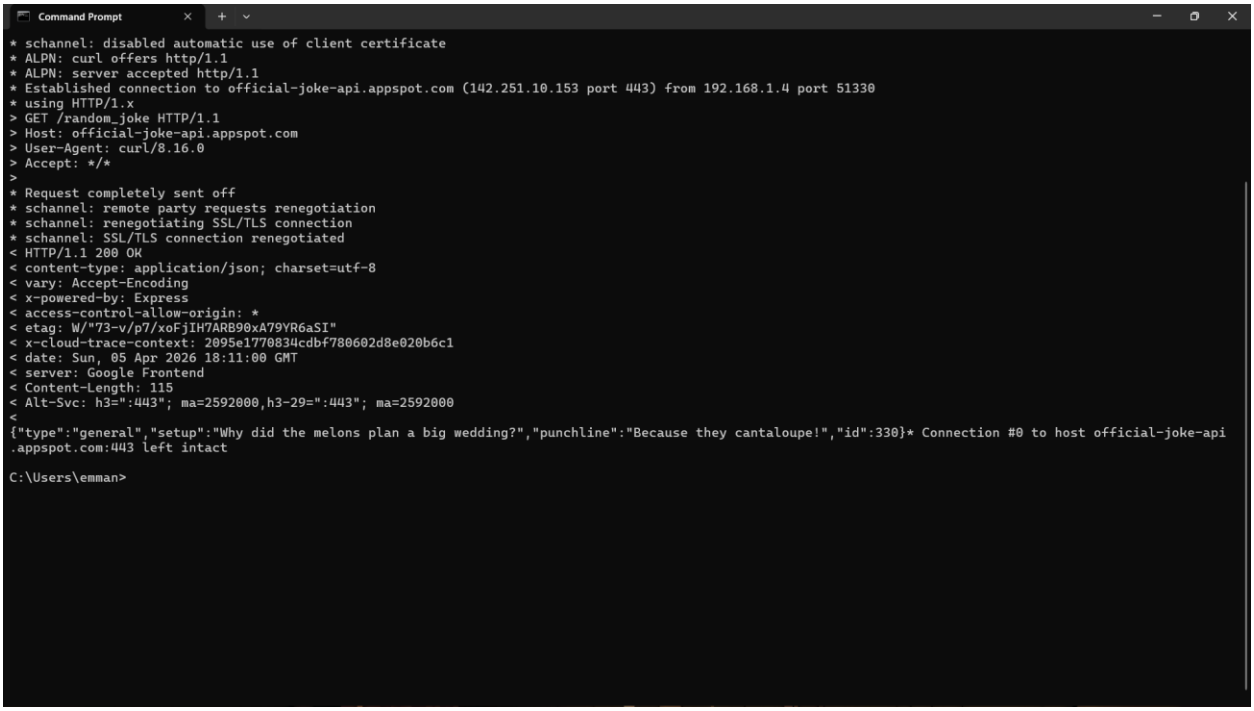
**Objective:** Observe the four main building blocks of a Web API request (Endpoint, Method, Headers, Payload) using a public REST API.

Instructions:

1. **The Endpoint:** We will use a free, public API that returns random programming jokes. The endpoint is https://official-joke-api.appspot.com/random_joke.
2. **The Method:** Open your terminal and use the 'curl' command to make a **GET** request
   (which retrieves data). Run
   a. curl -v https://official-joke-api.appspot.com/random_joke
      i. (Note: The -v flag stands for 'verbose' and will show you the hidden headers).
3. **Analyze the Output:** Look at the terminal output. You will see lines starting with > (your request) and < (the server's response).



```
Command Prompt
* schannel: disabled automatic use of client certificate
* ALPN: curl offers http/1.1
* ALPN: server accepted http/1.1
* Established connection to official-joke-api.appspot.com (142.251.10.153 port 443) from 192.168.1.4 port 51330
* using HTTP/1.x
> GET /random_joke HTTP/1.1
> Host: official-joke-api.appspot.com
> User-Agent: curl/8.16.0
> Accept: */*
>
* Request completely sent off
* schannel: remote party requests renegotiation
* schannel: renegotiating SSL/TLS connection
* schannel: SSL/TLS connection renegotiated
< HTTP/1.1 200 OK
< content-type: application/json; charset=utf-8
< vary: Accept-Encoding
< x-powered-by: Express
< access-control-allow-origin: *
< etag: W/"73-v/p7/xoFjIH7ARB90xA79YR6aSI"
< x-cloud-trace-context: 2095e1770834cdbf780602d8e020b6c1
< date: Sun, 05 Apr 2026 18:11:00 GMT
< server: Google Frontend
< Content-Length: 115
< Alt-Svc: h3=":443"; ma=2592000,h3-29=":443"; ma=2592000
<
{"type":"general","setup":"Why did the melons plan a big wedding?","punchline":"Because they cantaloupe!","id":330}* Connection #0 to host official-joke-api
.appspot.com:443 left intact

C:\Users\emman>
```

**Observations:**

- The API request successfully returned a random programming joke. The verbose mode showed both the request and response headers. The data was structured in JSON format, which is commonly used in REST APIs.

4. **Questions**
   a. Identify the **Method** used in the output.
   - The method used is GET.

   ```
   > GET /random_joke HTTP/1.1
   ```

   b. Identify one **Header** returned by the server (e.g., Content-Type).
   - One header returned by the server is

   ```
   < content-type: application/json;
   ```

   c. What format is the **Payload** (the actual joke data) returned in?
   - The payload is returned in JSON format.